

Configure the SmartScreen Filter

In Internet Explorer 8, Microsoft introduced the SmartScreen filter, a new measure to protect users against phishing attempts and malware. The SmartScreen filter tests the URL a user is trying to access against a list of blacklisted URLs that are known to contain malware. In IE9 Microsoft extended this to downloaded files as well.

Now in Windows 8 this is a core part of the system, and will test files downloaded from the internet by any application, not just Internet Explorer. It is a good initial measure against malware, and should probably not be turned off unless you have another antivirus software installed. Even so if you wish to configure it or turn it off, here is how you can do that:

- ▶ Open the Control Panel
- ▶ Open Action Center which can be found under System and Security, you can just search for it
- ▶ On the left you find a link titled “Change Windows SmartScreen settings”, click on it.

This will open a dialog that lets you opt between three levels of protection for the SmartScreen filter. The highest level of protection will require you to provide administrator approval before running any unrecognised application; which could mean clicking Yes on a UAC prompt, or entering a password. The second level of protection simply warns you before running such an application, but needs no approval. The final option is to simply have the filter turned off.

Filling a Start Menu-Shaped Hole

OK, so yes, Windows 8 does not have a Start Menu, and that is probably not something many people will like. Depending on what you used the

Start Menu for though, there are solutions available.

Windows 7 decreased reliance on the Start Menu by allowing you to pin commonly used applications on the taskbar itself. Furthermore if you needed to launch a lesser used application, all you needed to do is press the Start Menu button on your keyboard and start typing the name of the application in question, select the correct application from the list and press enter.



This menu will do if you need just the bare minimum